橋 MIRAI-SETU 2026 · KYUSHU A

Building Bridges That Last

Group Action Plan

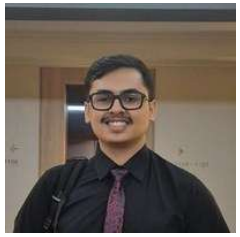
Our journey in Japan may be ending, but the connections we have built should continue.

INDIA × JAPAN · NOVEMBER 2026



Meet the Team

Eleven students from IIT Guwahati, IIT Madras and IIITDM Jabalpur · Kyushu A group



Aarsh Jain

IIT Guwahati
Yaskawa, Seiko



Anmol Singhal

IIITDM Jabalpur
Yaskawa, Seiko



Siddhant Chauhan

IIITDM Jabalpur
Saga Toyopet



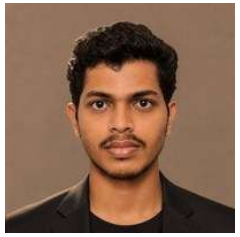
Sparsh Shukla

IIITDM Jabalpur
BPLUST



Aabhas Malpani

IIITDM Jabalpur
Hubest, ASO Group



Meghraj Shinde

IIITDM Jabalpur
MIZ



Aarya Shisode

IIT Guwahati
Nakayama Iron Works



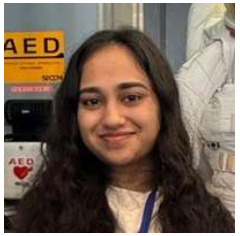
Adarsh Gyan Priyadarshi

IIITDM Jabalpur
Nakayama Iron Works



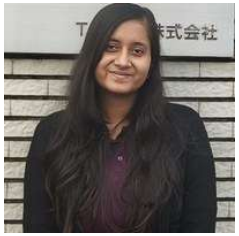
Aryan Pansare

IIITDM Jabalpur
Renesas, RIX



Nandini Maheshwari

IIT Madras
Saga Toyopet



Divya Gupta

IIT Madras
TOTO, Matsumoto

Our Journey at a Glance

Tokyo → Kyushu → Kansai → Hamamatsu → Yamanashi → Tokyo

I	旅	**Our Journey**	One month in Japan, the places we visited and the programs that impressed us most	**4 – 7**
II	文	**Cultural Exchange**	Heritage and peace, everyday life, language, and feeling at home	**8 – 13**
III	業	**Corporate Internship**	Who went where, internship moments, skills and host feedback	**14 – 18**
IV	道	**Action Plan**	Recommendations, our website, the best month to run the program	**19 – 23**

旅

ACT I

Our Journey

Where we went, and the programs that made the biggest difference.



One Month, Many Perspectives

A journey of learning, discovery and meaningful connections in Japan.

Tokyo — Kyushu — Kansai — Hamamatsu — Yamanashi — Tokyo



Nagasaki Peace Park · MIRAI-Setu participants

Cultural immersion

Traditions, food and daily life: the APU festival, Beppu, Dazaifu Shrine and the Nagasaki peace study.

University visits

Six universities: research, laboratories and career pathways.

Corporate visits

TCS Japan, JAXA, VeBuIn, Suzuki, Alfred and the Yonekurayama site.

Eight-day internships

Host companies in Fukuoka, Oita and Saga.

Workshops and networking

Keynote, TCS Ideathon, Indian professionals in Japan, the Consulate General of India and the Mayor of Hamamatsu.

Universities and Companies We Visited

Six universities and a range of companies, from space agencies to automakers.

UNIVERSITIES

東京大学 THE UNIVERSITY OF TOKYO

KYUSHU UNIVERSITY

Ritsumeikan APU

Beppu

KYOTO UNIVERSITY FOUNDED 1897

Shizuoka University

Hamamatsu

UNIVERSITY OF YAMANASHI

COMPANIES AND SITES

TATA CONSULTANCY SERVICES tcs

JAXA

Space agency

VeBuIn

Suzuki

Automotive

アルフレッド Alfred

Yonekurayama

Site visit



Kyushu University



Kyoto University



Shizuoka University



Suzuki Motor, Hamamatsu

Company visits felt personal: we already use their products.

Programs That Impressed Us Most

As we consider future careers in Japan: internships, university and industry visits, JAXA and Japanese work culture.



Aabhas Malpani

"University visits inspired me to pursue research."



Aarsh Jain

"The JAXA control room was truly unforgettable."



Meghraj Shinde

"The internship let me apply my skills to real challenges."



Sparsh Shukla

"The eight-day internship built my skills and industry exposure."



Aarya Shisode

"The corporate internship gave me practical industry exposure."



Divya Gupta

"I valued the exposure to Japanese work culture and corporate etiquette."



Aryan Pansare

"The internship clarified Japanese business culture and career paths."



Nandini Maheshwari

"I learned a great deal about Japanese work culture and networking."



Siddhant Chauhan

"Visiting Suzuki Motor made me want to become an automotive engineer."



Adarsh Gyan Priyadarshi

"Japan's countryside and its warm people became a second home."



Anmol Singhal

"The Yaskawa robots deepened my passion for automation."

KEY TAKEAWAY

Internships, industry, academia and culture together shaped our career goals in Japan.

文

ACT II

Cultural Exchange

The places we visited, the life we lived, and how language shaped our experience.



Heritage, Peace and Nature

Places across Japan that showed us where the country comes from.



Dazaifu Tenmangu

A shrine to the deity of learning. We took part in the purification ritual.



Nagasaki Peace Park

Bombed on 9 August 1945. The city says: “Let Nagasaki be the last.”



Beppu Jigoku

Volcanic hot springs, including the blue Umi Jigoku.



Fushimi Inari, Kyoto

Thousands of torii gates along the mountain path.



Karatsu Castle

A castle town in Saga, visited with our hosts.



Yoshinogari

An ancient Yayoi-period village site in Saga.

Everyday Life in Japan

A few highlights from living in Japan for a month.

Konbini

Fresh food, ATMs and services, open 24 hours.

7-Eleven

Konbini

Buses and trains

On time to the minute, quiet and orderly.

Punctuality

Being on time shows respect for other people’s time.

Hospitality

Sincere care for guests, with nothing expected in return.



A Japanese meal



Trying a yukata



Main street in Hamamatsu



City skyline at dusk

Language Barriers

It never stopped the work. It limited the bonds.

WHAT WORKED

- **Interpreters and translators**
  Arranged by AFS throughout our visits.
- **English at stations**
  Signs and announcements helped us travel.
- **Gestures and simple English**
  Enough for everyday needs.
- **AFS Japan staff**
  Unofficial interpreters who helped us find beef-free and meat-free food in konbini.

WHAT GOT LOST

- **Casual conversation**
  Small talk with hosts and colleagues.
- **Deeper understanding**
  Of the people and the culture around us.
- **Food**
  Finding suitable meals was a daily challenge.
- **Lab explanations**
  Details at the labs we visited.





Welcome party in Saga, and time with our hosts

A translator carries information, not rapport.

Bridging the Language Gap

Practical steps before, during and after the program.

BEFORE

- Select 2–3 months earlier, so there is time to learn Japanese (for example with the Busuu app)
- Attend regular Japanese lessons in India

DURING

- A student buddy for informal conversation beyond AFS staff
- Host companies could extend internships, so interns keep learning Japanese

AFTER

- Keep in touch through online language exchange
- Build a stronger alumni network

TWO SOLUTIONS

A trusted course list

AFS India shares reliable online Japanese courses and tutors, so students do not have to guess.

A weekly language hour

A short Japanese session during the program, led by AFS staff or local volunteers.

Food and Comfort

Small changes that help participants feel at home in Japan.

FOOD

- More Indian meals near host companies and hotels
- Vegan and vegetarian options at konbini
- Dietary needs shared with hosts and restaurants before arrival

COMMUNICATION

- English labels and menus that show meat, fish and dairy clearly
- A short phrase card for dietary needs
- Basic English support for hosts

COMMUNITY

- Indian festivals celebrated together in Japan
- More cross-cultural events and joint activities
- Meals and visits with local families







業

ACT III

Corporate Internship

Eight days inside Japanese companies: where we went, what we built and what we learned.



Who Went Where

12 host companies · 11 interns · Week 1 (13–16 Oct) → Week 2 (19–22 Oct)

YASKAWA Global → SEIKO ELECTRIC



Aarsh Jain

IIT Guwahati



Anmol Singhal

IIITDM Jabalpur

ヒューベストホールディング → 麻生グループ



Aabhas Malpani

IIITDM Jabalpur

RENESAS → RIX



Aryan Pansare

IIITDM Jabalpur

BPLUST



Sparsh Shukla

IIITDM Jabalpur

MIZ 株式会社ミズ



Meghraj Shinde

IIITDM Jabalpur

Nakayama



Adarsh Priyadarshi

IIITDM Jabalpur



Aarya Shisode

IIT Guwahati

佐賀トヨペット



Siddhant Chauhan

IIITDM Jabalpur



Nandini Maheshwari

IIT Madras

TOTO → MATSUMOTO



Divya Gupta

IIT Madras

Internship Moments

Eight days of real projects, hosted by people who made us feel welcome.



Yaskawa Electric and Seiko Electric



ASO Group



Renesas Electronics and RIX



BPLUST



MIZ



Nakayama Iron Works



Saga Toyopet



TOTO and Matsumoto Industry

Skills Across Our Hosts

Skills each host company's work called for, from our project reports.

	Simulation	Vision and 3D sensing	Data analytics	IoT and monitoring	Anomaly detection	Service and product design	Software and platforms	Site observation
Yaskawa Electric Robotics	●	●						
Seiko Electric Port systems				○	●			
Hubest Holding					—			
ASO Group Consulting								○
Renesas Electronics Semiconductors					—			
RIX Corporation Services				○	○	●		
BPLUST Media and IT services					—			
MIZ Healthcare							●	
Nakayama Iron Works Crushers, micro-hydro			●	●	○			
Saga Toyopet Automotive, mobility			●			●	●	
TOTO Bathware					—			
Matsumoto Industry					—			

● hands-on work ○ studied or observed

What Our Hosts Said

Feedback from our host companies after the internships.

YASKAWA Global

To Anmol Singhal and Aarsh Jain

“When I listened to your presentations today, I could see that you had a wonderful four days, and that made me very happy.”

Kana Hayashi
Yaskawa Electric Corporation

麻生グループ WE DELIVER THE BEST

To Aabhas Malpani

“It was a pleasure to meet such promising young people who will help shape the future of our world.”

Teppei Uchimura
ASO Group

MIZ 株式会社ミズ

To Meghraj Shinde

“Your engineering skills, problem-solving mindset, and passion for technology have inspired our entire company.”

Yamamoto Takao
Deputy General Manager, Community Relations and Engagement Division, MIZ Co.

Nakayama

To Aarya Shisode and Adarsh Gyan Priyadarshi

“Demonstrated commendable commitment, professionalism and enthusiasm for learning. Conduct, dedication and overall performance were highly appreciated.”

Kenichiro Dan
Director, Product Development Section, Nakayama Holdings Ltd.

道

ACT IV

Action Plan

How we turn this experience into something that lasts.



Recommendations for Future Editions

From exposure to meaningful participation.



01

More company visits

University visits were highly technical, and in a short time it was hard to understand what each university does. Company visits felt more personal, because we already use products from companies like Suzuki. More of them would help us feel connected.

2–3

MONTHS EARLIER

02

Earlier selection

Select participants 2–3 months before departure, so that everyone has enough time to learn Japanese, for example with the Busuu app.



03

An Even Saturday

Keep Saturdays light and evenly paced, so the week is less hectic and there is time to rest. We believe exploring alone helps us understand the country better.

We Recommend October

June or October? Three reasons favor October.

1 No clash with internships

May to July is summer internship season for the students this program is designed for.

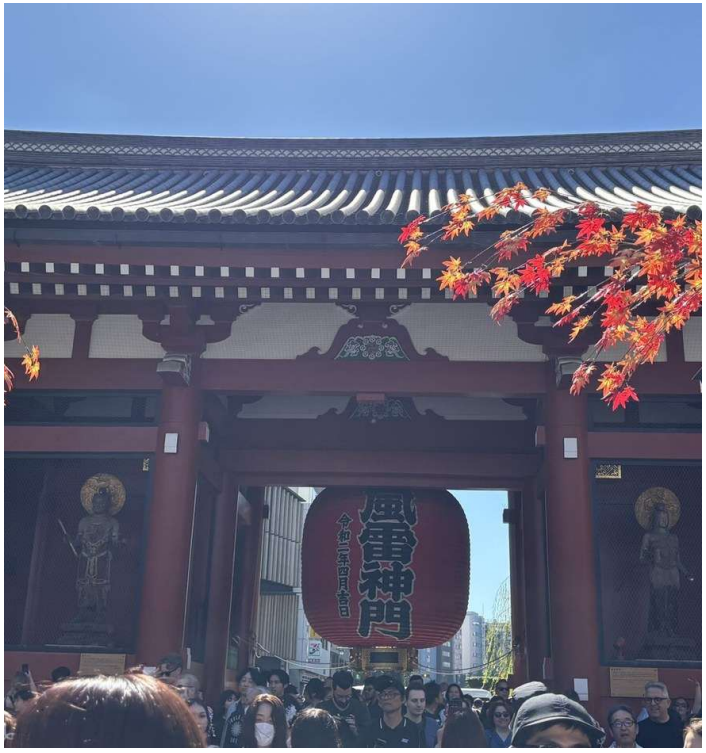
2 Better weather for travel

June is the rainy season: about 269 mm of rain in Fukuoka, compared with about 93 mm in October.

3 Already proven

The 2025 and 2026 groups both ran in October.

Our recommendation: October, after consulting universities, host companies and students.



Our Journey, Online

A website where every participant shares their own views, journey and learning.

1 Individual views

Each of us shares our own perspective, which is hard to present in a single session.

2 Our journey

Where we travelled, what we learned, and our personal challenges.

3 A portal for the future

Future participants can use it to prepare for Japan.

11 **participants today**
Our Kyushu A group

40 **participants next**
All MIRAI-Setu 2026 groups

Scan to read our stories

Student-created resource, not an official AFS or MOFA website.

Thank you

ありがとうございました

Learn Keep learning each other's languages and cultures.

Connect Keep the friendships and work relationships.

Collaborate Turn connections into academic, professional and cultural opportunities.

With sincere thanks to the Ministry of Foreign Affairs of Japan, AFS, our host companies, the universities and our interpreters, who made every conversation possible.






Kyushu A, together throughout the month

Our website